Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report on

Ty'r Eithin Cottage

Llanelli

Date Inspection Completed

17/07/2024

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About Ty'r Eithin Cottage

Type of care provided	Care Home Service Adults and Children Without Nursing
Registered Provider	Transform Residential Limited
Registered places	4
Language of the service	English
Previous Care Inspectorate Wales inspection	First Inspection following registration.
Does this service promote Welsh language and culture?	This service is working towards providing an 'Active Offer' of the Welsh language and intends to become a bilingual service or demonstrates a significant effort to promoting the Welsh language and culture.

Summary

Young people are supported to be independent and achieve their goals and aspirations. Assessments are carried out to ensure their needs can be met prior to offering a placement and is kept under ongoing review. Young people are supported with their learning and development and attend an education provision at Coleg Plas Dwbl. They have opportunities to engage in a range of activities which are outcome focused and promote their independent living skills. Young people are supported with their health needs and have access to specialist services such as occupational health and speech and language therapists.

The manager provides supervision to a core care staff team who are committed to their role in supporting the needs of young people. The Responsible Individual (RI) provides support to the manager and visits the service regularly. Quality assurance systems are in place which monitor the quality of care being delivered.

The service has two houses on site and are decorated to a high quality. The homes provide a holistic space for young people which is suitable to meet their needs. Externally there are large grounds for young people to spend time on nice days and areas where they can engage in outdoor activities.

Well-being

Young people are consulted about their care and support, and their voices are being heard. Weekly meetings take place which enable them to express their views and wishes and make decisions about their day to day lives. Weekly planners are developed with assistance from care staff and provide choices for meaningful activities they enjoy within the home and out in the community.

Young people are supported to grow their own fruit and vegetables at home and in college. They make choices about what meals they would like to eat and develop menus which reflect their likes and dislikes. Homegrown produce is used when cooking meals and they are encouraged to live healthy lifestyles.

Young people attend Coleg Plas Dwbl for their education and have opportunities to develop independent living skills which include horticulture, crafting, and woodworking. Suitable arrangements are in place to support young people to attend the college and positive lines of communication are held between the college and the service.

Young people are supported with their physical health needs and are registered with local health services. They are supported by care staff to attend regular appointments with GP's, opticians, dentists and specialist health services.

Medication is stored appropriately, and effective recording and monitoring systems are in place. Care staff are suitably trained in the handling and administration of medication.

Safeguarding recording and monitoring systems are in place to safeguard young people. A weekly safeguarding meeting is attended by college and care managers to monitor and discuss student's welfare and any possible concerns. Young people have access to guidance on how to raise concerns and are encouraged to voice their worries with care staff when they need to.

Young people are enabled to maintain positive relationships with people who are important to them and is supportive of their emotional well-being. They socialise with friends at college, youth clubs and discos and have a sense of community presence. Family members are actively involved in the care and support needs of young people and contact is promoted within the home.

Care and Support

Young people's care and support needs are suitably assessed prior to offering a placement. A transition system provides young people an opportunity to visit the service and build positive relations with peers and care staff before moving to the home. Risks and compatibility are considered, and a rationale on how the service can be delivered which keeps young people safe and live in a positive environment.

Young people have access to a guide which is suitable for the needs and understanding of each person. Information to the provision of the service is included, local amenities and leisure activities. A complaints procedure outlines how young people can raise concerns and contact information is available.

Personal plans are developed alongside young people and provide guidance to care staff on how they would achieve personal outcomes. We saw a range of different documents outlining young people's goals and aspirations which inform how they would like their care and support to be delivered. Information relating to health needs, cultural beliefs and people involved in their care is available. It is unclear from documents reviewed the extent to which parents and social workers are involved in the development of personal plans.

Positive behaviour plans outline young people's likes and dislikes and provide guidance on how they would like to maintain a positive sense of well-being. Restrictive intervention information is available however, further developments and clarity is needed within documentation.

Young people are encouraged to take positive risks when engaging in tasks or activities. Assessments are undertaken which provide guidance to care staff on how to keep them safe.

Care staff present as kind, caring and respectful. We saw positive interactions with young people and communication methods used to suit their needs.

Environment

The service consists of two homes in large rural grounds overlooking the countryside. The houses present as cosy, warm and well furnished. Both properties are homely and provide an environment which supports young people's overall well-being. Young people have access to various living areas where they can enjoy some quiet time or play games with peers or care staff.

Bedrooms are warm, spacious and decorated to the wishes of young people. Photographs of people who are important to them and artwork are located on the walls. Suitable storage has been provided for young people for clothing items. Bedrooms do not have en-suites however, designated bathrooms to carry out personal care are available.

Kitchen areas are clean, and cupboards and fridges are well stocked. Suitable equipment is available for young people to make meals. All temperatures on fridges were recorded consistently and a daily task sheet had been completed by care staff.

Outside provides opportunities for young people to engage with outdoor activities. Large grounds where they can access walk paths, grow vegetables and engage in woodworking. Care staff encourage young people to be outside and lead healthy lifestyles.

Young people have Personal Emergency Evacuation Plans (PEEP's) and provide guidance to care staff on how to support them during an emergency.

Health and safety is monitored and maintenance carried out when necessary. COSHH items were secure and locked away.

The service provider has a visitor's book, and we were asked to sign in and our identification verified on arrival.

Leadership and Management

The statement of purpose (SOP) provides detailed information in relation to the provision of the service and education provided by the college. The service is working towards the Welsh active offer and provides information to support young people to learn the Welsh language and its culture.

The service provider has robust quality of care systems. Processes are in place which monitor, review, improve the quality of care, and focus on driving improvement for young people.

The RI carries out regular visits and provides oversight and governance of the service. Analysis is carried out in relation to staffing, standards of care and support and any concerns raised. Consultation with young people and care staff are carried out and any actions considered to support their views.

The manager and care staff receive regular supervision discussions include personal development and training needs. From records reviewed a suitable probationary review system is in place and a focus on providing care staff with skills relevant to carry out their role effectively was evident.

Care staff are suitably qualified or are working towards their health and social care qualification. They undertake mandatory training, and most are up to date. Care staff told us they felt the training provided allows them to carry out their role effectively.

An effective rota system is in place which reflects suitable staffing levels for the care needs of young people. Shortfalls are covered by care staff and the manager which provides consistency and continuity for young people.

Team meetings are carried out regularly and are suitably attended by care staff. They provide a good insight into recent developments of young people and provide actions care staff need to take to improve the delivery of care.

Summary of Non-Compliance	
Status	**What each means**
New	This non-compliance was identified at this inspection.
Reviewed	Compliance was reviewed at this inspection and was not achieved. The target date for compliance is in the future and will be tested at next inspection.
Not Achieved	Compliance was tested at this inspection and was not achieved.
Achieved	Compliance was tested at this inspection and was achieved.

We respond to non-compliance with regulations where poor outcomes for people, and / or risk to people's well-being are identified by issuing Priority Action Notice (s).

The provider must take immediate steps to address this and make improvements. Where providers fail to take priority action by the target date we may escalate the matter to an Improvement and Enforcement Panel.

Priority Action Notice(s)		
Regulation	Summary	Status
N/A	No non-compliance of this type was identified at this inspection	N/A

Where we find non-compliance with regulations but no immediate or significant risk for people using the service is identified we highlight these as Areas for Improvement.

We expect the provider to take action to rectify this and we will follow this up at the next inspection. Where the provider has failed to make the necessary improvements we will escalate the matter by issuing a Priority Action Notice.

Area(s) for Improvement		
Regulation	Summary	Status

N/A	No non-compliance of this type was identified at this inspection	N/A

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